PROJECT PROPOSAL · ITC C508-401I

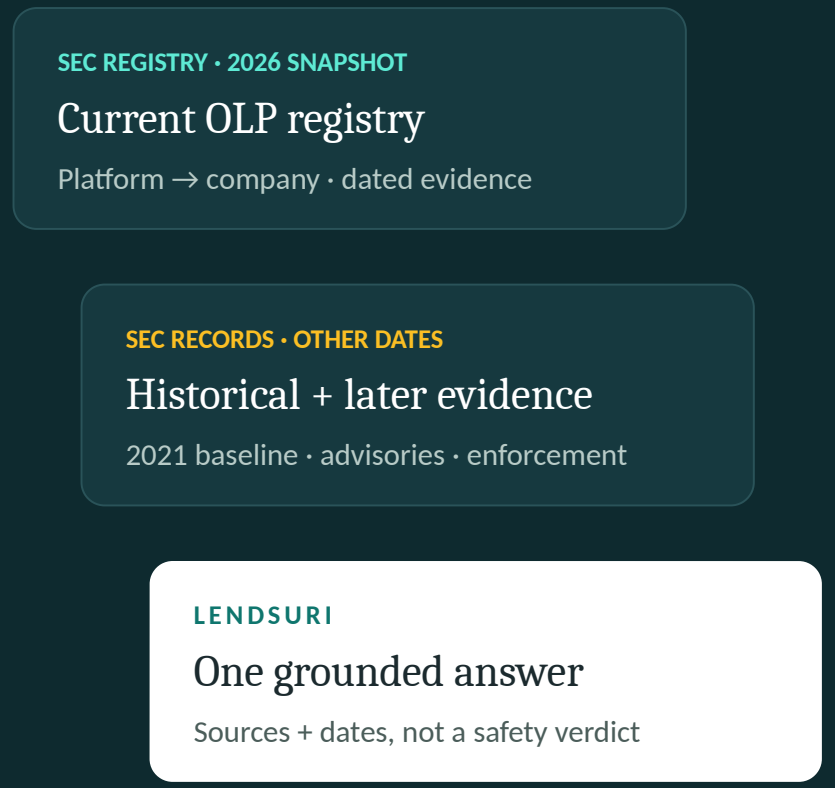
LendSuri

A cybersecurity-focused RAG chatbot for SEC regulatory record retrieval on Philippine Online Lending Platforms

suri — Filipino for "to examine closely"

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01 · THE PROBLEM

Borrowing went digital. So did deception.

23%

of TransUnion's general-population sample used money-lending apps

TransUnion Credit Perception Index, 2025

47,446

complaints about allegedly abusive online lending apps, Aug 2024 – Jan 2026

PAOCC, via INQUIRER.net, Mar 2026

3 agencies

DICT, NPC and SEC jointly flagged harassment, shaming and misuse of personal data by OLPs

Joint public advisory, Mar 2026

THE ISSUE THIS PAPER FOCUSES ON

SEC evidence changes across time

A platform may appear in a dated 2026 registry snapshot or older 2021 list, while a later SEC advisory or action changes how that evidence should be interpreted.

Registered company ≠ recorded OLP

Company registration and Certificate of Authority are separate from OLP disclosure and recording, so one record cannot stand in for the other.

→ **LendSuri compares dated SEC evidence and explains it with sources, without declaring a platform safe.**

02 · TARGET AUDIENCE

Who LendSuri is for

PRIMARY USERS

Filipino consumers who come across, or are thinking of using, an online lending app, website or related platform

- Ask in English, Filipino or Taglish
- Need short, clear explanations
- Want the SEC's evidence, not opinions

The SEC itself advises borrowers to verify a lender and its OLP through official SEC records before transacting.

WHEN THEY'D REACH FOR IT

Before borrowing

Checking whether an app or website appears in the dated SEC registry snapshot before signing up.

Checking records across time

Asking whether a current or historical SEC record is affected by a newer advisory or regulatory action.

Reporting a problem

Finding the SEC complaint procedure that fits what the records show.

“

How effectively can a standard RAG-based chatbot retrieve and provide accurate, grounded explanations of available SEC regulatory records and applicable SEC guidance for Online Lending Platforms in the Philippines?

ONE PLATFORM TYPE

Online Lending Platforms

ONE AUTHORITY

The Philippine SEC

SDG 16 · TARGET 16.10

Public access to information

Current registry + historical + later SEC evidence

A Current SEC OLP registry snapshot

Dated 2026 snapshot of the SEC registry

Primary positive-registry evidence: OLP name and associated lending/financing company. The snapshot date is preserved.

B Historical SEC OLP records

SEC list · updated Nov 29, 2021

Historical baseline only. Used to compare earlier OLP records with newer registry entries and later SEC regulatory evidence.

C Current framework & disclosure

MC No. 20 · OLP Disclosure Guide · 2026

Current prudential, disclosure and market-conduct context. MC No. 20 also lifted the previous moratorium on new OLPs.

D SEC advisories & regulatory actions

Unrecorded · unauthorized · enforcement

Later advisories, suspensions, revocations and related actions can change how earlier registry evidence should be interpreted.

E · COMPLAINT + STORAGE

- Registered lenders/OLPs → SEC iMessage
- Lending without a CA → SEC EIPD
- CSV + normalized PDF; every item keeps source/date
- Fixed knowledge-base cutoff for reproducibility

BSP is supporting research context only; the SEC remains the regulatory authority.

05 · LANGUAGE MODEL

Llama-SEA-LION-v3-8B-IT

~8B
parameters

128K
tokens of context

FIL + EN
both officially supported

0
fine-tuning runs planned

Instruction-tuned by AI Singapore for Southeast Asian languages. A preliminary choice: its performance will be measured, not assumed.

WHY THIS MODEL

Speaks the users' language

Users may ask in English, Filipino, or a mix. Filipino was part of its continued pretraining.

Explains, doesn't recall

Its job is to explain the SEC records placed in its context, not to answer from memory.

Stays current without retraining

SEC information is time-sensitive, so new records update the corpus, not the weights.

Fits student hardware

A quantized version or hosted inference can work around limited Colab GPU memory.

06 · OUT OF SCOPE

What LendSuri won’t do, and doesn’t need

WON’T DO

Recommend lenders

It reports what SEC records say, not which lender to pick.

Guarantee a platform is safe

A record is evidence at a point in time, not a safety guarantee.

Investigate crimes

Criminal matters and liability belong to enforcement authorities.

Detect malware

It tackles an information problem, not attacks or offenders.

Give loan advice

Nor can it recover lost funds; money decisions stay with the user.

Route users to other agencies

Complaint guidance stays limited to official SEC procedures.

Why draw the line here? It keeps LendSuri focused on one manageable, measurable information problem, not a general finance or scam-reporting assistant.

DOESN’T NEED

Fine-tuning

SEC records change, so the knowledge base is updated instead of the model.

Other agencies as authority

The SEC stays the regulatory authority; BSP is supporting research context only.

A separate language study

Filipino and Taglish questions are tested inside the same evaluation.

How we'll measure it

~30

test questions, kept separate from the knowledge base

- Mostly answerable from the SEC corpus
- A few intentionally unanswerable
- Some in Filipino or Taglish
- Current-registry, historical + later-action cases
- Expected answers + source passages set in advance



Retrieval accuracy

Does the expected SEC source appear among the retrieved documents?



Answer correctness

Does the response agree with the verified expected answer?



Groundedness

Are the important claims supported by the retrieved evidence?



Unavailable-info handling

Do unsupported questions get an "insufficient evidence" reply, not a guess?

Salamat po! Questions? LendSuri doesn't decide who's safe. It shows what the SEC says.